Soviet Socialist Republics (USSR) in 1991. Over time, countries in the European Union (E.U.) and the UnitedStates have faced stagnation and recession, while several southern states have shown high growth and economic development levels. This trend catalyzed several changes within the international political and economic system. Following the Cold War between USSR and America in the mid-twentieth century, the United States of America (USA) emerged as a dominant international political player. However, it faced political resistance from both Russia and China, who sought to construct a new economic structure made up of several global powers, including themselves. China and Russia's international relations activities have resulted in what is known as a ‘multipolar’ political and economic system of international order. China, Russia, and other global south countries challenge the earlier ‘bipolar’ model based on a duality between the East and the West.

Evolution of China as a Global Player

Historically, China was not an active player in international relations. Therefore, China's evolution is classified into three distinct phases. The first phase included the period between 1950 and 1970 when it kept rejecting the existing international order. In the next step, it took on a more passive position between 1980 and 1990. And in the 2000s, when China wanted to take on a more selective and activist role, it sought international institution's membership. It tried to learn the road rules, obeying them mostly (Shambaugh 2009: 125).[1] However, from 1950 to 1970, China's worldview was guided by Mao Zedong's Three Worlds theory. According to such an approach, the first world consisted of two superpowers, the other developed countries known as the ‘Second World.’ The third of the developing countries known as the ‘Third World,’ Beijing's leadership gave China the status of a Third World country and regarded itself as the Third World (Wang and Rosenau 2009).[2]

Later, China thought to be an active player in international relations. It needed to integrate with global organizations. From December 1978 onwards, China stopped the earlier development strategy followed by China for over three decades and launched an economic reform process, opening up to the outside world. China assumed a seat in the World Bank in 1980 (World Bank 2005).[3] Afterward, the structure of China's society, culture, and the